

MA#IC is real; physicist thinks

**A neurodivergent self portrait
in the form of a slide deck.**

Benji Metha, Oct 9

What is neurodiversity?

- People with abnormal brains
- This is natural. This is okay.
- “Everyone in the world knows something you don’t” — Bill Nye, 100/10 science communicator

What is bipolar?

- There are 2 kinds: Type 1 and Type II.
- Type 1 lets you reach hypomania
- Type 2 lets you reach full-on mania
- I have Type 2. Its easier to treat but it's also very intense

Who else had bipolar?

(opinions I can get citations about)

Kanye West. Lewis Carroll. Richard Garfield, PhD. Leonardo Da Vinci. Ancient people in ancient cultures. Brandon Sanderson, probably.

John Lennon and shamans used drugs to get where I am.

**Q: What is the ancient word for
Mania?**

A: MANA

citations available on reQuest

Corollary:
I am... a wizard?

You've read my resume

I'm well read and know how to learn and teach

The binary nature of bipolar:

- I become EXTREMELY neurodivergent.
- I get three different disorders and three different superpowers.

Pros(e):

- I become very creative
- I become hyperintelligent
- I have an endless tap of inspiration.

Cons:

- I become very ADHD and autistic
- I have no short term memory rn
- After the high I get depression for 3 months. It's 1 for 3.

Q: How can you help?

Cycle 5 edits

Onboarding

A: Give me stuff to do!

Stimulating conversations with strangers

A: Help me focus

You're already doing great at that

Thank you Vivian

8-4 Work, 5-7 Art?

A: flexible work hours

How flexible can we make them?

Q: How can I help myself?

Focus on mindfulness

Acceptance and commitment therapy

SciComm CubeSats
& other inventions

A: Art Therapy

Stimulating conversations with strangers

Phone calls back home

By October I will have...

3 months of depression

...but I'm planning for that, too

- I will now take harder meds when I travel
 - I will be inspired to come into work because I work at heckin' CALTECH
 - It will be sunny so no seasonal depression
 - I have 3 months worth of drugs
-
- But I need to see a doctor.